WebMCP Experiment Report

Can we make online shopping easier for AI assistants? | 27 September 2026

1. What was this experiment about?

More and more, people ask AI assistants (like ChatGPT, Alexa-style bots, or browsing agents) to do things for them online: "*Find me a wireless mouse under ₹1,500 and order it.*"

Today, an AI assistant visiting a **normal website** has to do this the hard way — the way a person with no eyes would: it reads the raw code of the page, guesses where the buttons are, opens every product page, and pieces the information together. It is slow, error-prone, and expensive (every page read costs AI "thinking power").

WebMCP is a new idea: the website itself offers the AI a tidy menu of ready-made actions — *search products, get details, add to cart, checkout* — like a proper service counter instead of a self-service warehouse. The AI asks for exactly what it needs and gets exactly that.

> **The question we tested:** does a website built with WebMCP let an AI assistant complete shopping tasks better than a normal website?

2. How we tested it

We built **two identical online shops** — same design, same 30 real products (10 mice, 10 laptops, 10 phones, Indian prices), same cart and checkout. The only difference:

Shop	Address	What's different
Normal shop	demonomcp.converso.work	No special AI features
WebMCP shop	demowithmcp.converso.work	Offers AI a menu of 5 direct actions

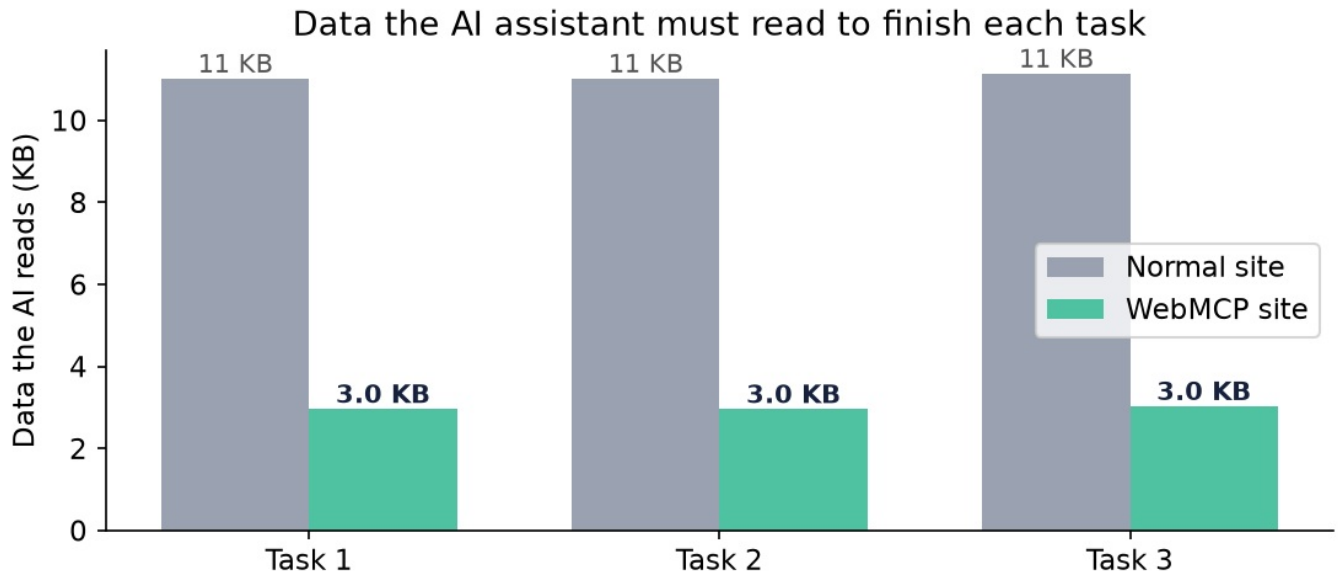
We then gave an AI assistant the **same 3 shopping tasks** on both shops:

#	Task given to the AI	Correct answer
1	Find a wireless mouse under ₹1,500 (cheapest wins)	Portronics Toad 32 — ₹749
2	Find the cheapest laptop rated 4.3★ or better	HP Pavilion 14 — ₹52,990
3	Find the highest-rated phone under ₹30,000 and place the order	Redmi Note 13 Pro — ₹21,999

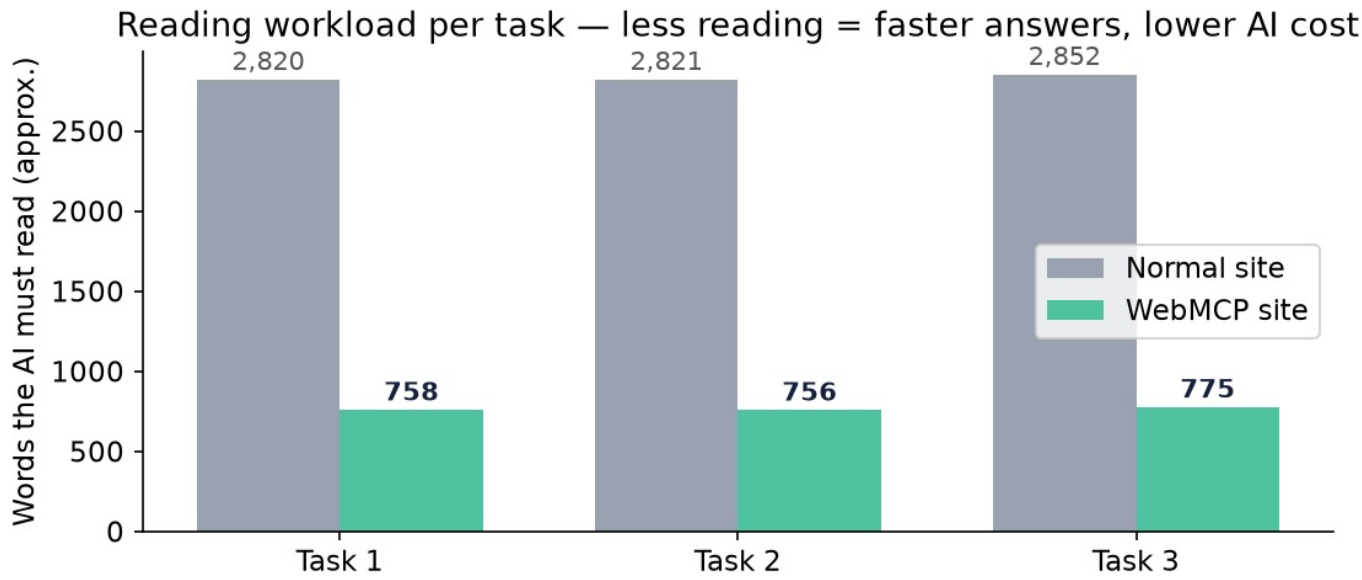
3. The results

Both AI assistants completed **all 3 tasks correctly** and picked **identical products** — the experiment was fair. The difference was **how much work** each had to do:

> # 74% less
>
> On the WebMCP shop, the AI read **74% less data** to achieve the same correct results.



Data read by the AI per task. On the normal shop, the AI must pull the entire 30-product catalogue and read all of it. On the WebMCP shop, the site itself filters and returns only matching products.



Same data expressed as approximate "words the AI must read". Less reading means faster answers and lower AI processing cost — this is where real money is saved when the AI runs on a paid model.

Parameter	Normal shop	WebMCP shop	Winner
Tasks completed correctly	**3 / 3**	**3 / 3**	Tie
Products chosen (correctness)	All 3 correct	All 3 correct	Tie
Data the AI had to read	33,971 characters	**9,157 characters**	**WebMCP (−74%)**
Approx. words the AI reads	~8,500	**~2,300**	**WebMCP**
Steps (requests) per run of 3 tasks	10	13	Normal (WebMCP pays a small one-time "introduce yourself" cost)
Time (same machine, same network)	0.08 s	0.08 s	Tie

	Task 1	Task 2	Task 3
Normal site	✓ Portronics Toad 32	✓ HP Pavilion 14	✓ Redmi Note 13 Pro
WebMCP site	✓ Portronics Toad 32	✓ HP Pavilion 14	✓ Redmi Note 13 Pro

Both shops led the AI to the same products — WebMCP changed the journey, not the destination.

4. What does this mean? (In plain words)

Think of two libraries. In the first, you're handed *every book in the building* and told "the answer is somewhere in here." In the second, a librarian asks "what do you need?" and hands you the *one page* you wanted. Both get you the answer. The second is dramatically less effort — and that's what WebMCP did for our AI shopper.

- **Fewer mistakes as shops grow:** our catalogue was only 30 products. A real shop has thousands — the normal shop forces the AI to read all of them; WebMCP keeps sending only the handful that match. The bigger the shop, the bigger the advantage.
- **Cheaper AI bills:** AI services charge by how much they read. ~8,500 words vs ~2,300 words for the same shopping trip is roughly a 4× cost difference at scale.
- **More reliable:** the AI no longer depends on guessing how a website's buttons are wired — the website tells it directly. Fewer wrong clicks, fewer dead ends.
- **Good for humans too:** the WebMCP shop looked and worked exactly the same for a human visitor. Customers notice nothing; their AI assistant does.

5. Honest limitations

- **Speed looked identical** because both shops ran on the same nearby server. On the real internet with a real AI model, the smaller data load would also mean visibly faster replies.
- **The AI helper in this run followed fixed shopping logic** (the same "brain" for both shops), so we measured the website's effect cleanly. A fully free-thinking AI would add some randomness to both sides.
- **Three tasks, 30 products** — a proof of concept, not a large-scale study. The pattern is expected to strengthen (not weaken) with bigger catalogues.

6. Verdict

> **The experiment supports the idea.** For an AI assistant, the WebMCP shop completed every task with **74% less reading, identical accuracy**, at the cost of a few extra setup calls that get repaid the moment tasks are repeated. For businesses: adding WebMCP to a web shop is a small change to the website and a large saving for every AI that shops there.

Prepared by Hermes Agent · Test data: /root/webmcp_demo/results.json · Shops: demonomcp.converso.work (normal) · demowithmcp.converso.work (WebMCP)

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